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ATT. περυσινός (MYC. *PE-RU-SI-NU-WO*) 'LAST YEAR'S'

1. The forms of the Greek adjective meaning 'last year's' — Att. περυσινός [Aristoph.+],[1] cf. Myc. (KN, PY, MY) *pe-ru-si-nu-wo*[2] — are clearly based on the well-known PIE adverb **pér-ut-i* 'last year' (as in Gk. πέρυσι(ν) [Dor. πέρυτι(ς)], Ved. *parút*, Arm. *heru*, ON *í fjǫrð* 'id.'), containing a reduced form of the loc. sg. of **u̯et-* 'year'.[3] The problem with this adjective is notorious: its Proto-Greek (or pre-Mycenaean) form **perutinu̯o-* displays an obscure formation, as if the adverb **pér-ut-i* has been extended by an otherwise unknown adjectival formant "**-nu̯o-*", containing an intrusive labial glide as compared with ordinary adjectival **-nó-*. No credible explanation for this formation has been offered so far.[4]

2. There is a great deal of confusion about this problem in the literature, given, first of all, the phonological ambiguity of Att. περυσινός (< **-ino-* or **-inu̯o-*), and secondly because of the existence of a class of "time-adjectives" in -ινός, such as Hom. εἰαρινός 'in spring',[5] and more than a dozen other post-Homeric forms of this kind. As a result, περυσινός and its Mycenaean counterpart are usually put together with these -ινός adjectives, a situation that has led to two unfortunate consequences:

[1] Attic only, despite CHANTRAINE 1933, p. 201 ("ionien-attique").

[2] And other inflected forms: f. gen. pl. *pe-ru-si-nwa-o*, etc.

[3] For further detail on PIE **pér-ut-i*, see GRIEPENTROG 1995, pp. 444ff., with references. On the root noun **u̯et-* and its relationship with the *s*-stem **u̯ét-os/*u̯et-es-*: VINE 2009.

[4] The problem is signaled, for example, by FRISK (GEW II, p. 518), who cites *pe-ru-si-nu-wo* "mit unerklärtem Ϝ"; more recently e.g. MEIER-BRÜGGER 1992, vol. II, p. 23 ("die Herkunft des *-u̯-* in myk. *-inu̯o-* ist umstritten"), and MEISSNER 2006, p. 206n106 (/perusinu̯o-/ is described as a "secondarily formed" adjective, but without explanation).

[5] With metrical lengthening in the initial syllable; otherwise in Homer only ὀπωρῑνός 'in autumn', perhaps for *ὀπωαρινός; see DE LAMBERTERIE 2003, p. 129 on Ὡρίων and Ὠαρίων. More on this form in §**2.1** below.

(*a*) confusing assertions that these adjectives in -ινός are already attested in Mycenaean,[6] and similarly (but still worse) that -ινός (as in *Ionic* εἰαρινός) "goes back to **-nwo-*";[7] and (*b*) the prevailing contamination analysis of *pe-ru-si-nu-wo*.

2.1. As for the first point: Ionic -ινός, with *short* /i/, cannot in fact go back to a form like the /*perusinu̯o-*/ of Mycenaean (given the operation of compensatory lengthening in resonant plus glide sequences in Ionic); and there is, moreover, little independent reason to think that Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo* (which *can* be directly continued in Att. περυσινός) has anything directly to do with the mainly post-Homeric seasonal and time-of-day adjectives in -ινός. The formant -ινός (i.e., historically, loc. sg. **-i* + adjectival **-nó-*) is a more marginal "delocative" adjectival formation in Greek than -ιος, which is better-attested in Homer (including the seasonal term χειμέριος 'in winter', cf. post-Hom. χειμερινός 'id.'). Further, the spread of -ινός (first to other seasonal terms, then mainly to "time of day" terms) is essentially a post-Homeric development; and indeed, among the *latest* -ινός creations is τητινός 'this year's' (: Att. τῆτες 'this year', cf. Myc. *za-we-te* 'id.').[8] At best, the only viable candidate for an actual formation of the type /*perusinu̯o-*/ is Hom. ὀπωρῑνός (cf. n. 5): RUIJGH has suggested (2006, p. 160) that the odd lengthening in the suffix could be explained by positing a preform *ὀπωρινϜός, analogically formed on the model of /*perusinu̯o-*/, rather than by "metrical lengthening" (as generally assumed).

2.2. Indeed, it can be said that the cost of maintaining the connection between Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo* and the -ινός adjectives (apart from ὀπωρῑνός) is precisely the widely-accepted contamination theory proposed by LEJEUNE[9]: according to this account, **peruti-nó-* 'last year's' contaminated with the adjective **néu̯o-* 'new' (a virtual synonym, it is claimed, of 'this year's') results in the monstrous form "**perutinu̯ó-*". This theory derives superficial support from texts like MY Oe 111, in which *pe-ru-si-nwa* appears to correlate with *ne[-wa]*, thus contrasting 'last year's' with 'new' (referring to textiles for distribution, or the like),

[6] E.g. MEIER-BRÜGGER loc. cit. (n. 4): "Die Adj. auf -ινός sind bereits myk. belegt" (with reference to *pe-ru-si-nu-wo*).

[7] So e.g. PALMER 1980, p. 255.

[8] The classic study of -ινός adjectives is SZEMERÉNYI 1959 (but note FRIEDMAN 2003, pp. 3f. on χειμερινός). The morphology of τῆτες, Myc. *za-we-te* is discussed in detail in VINE 2009.

[9] See *DMic.* vol. 2, pp. 113f., for references and adherents.

among other MY and KN texts where a form of /*perusinu̯os*/ is indeed paired on the surface with a form of /*neu̯os*/. But various objections to this proposal can be raised. We also find texts like PY Ma 225, in which *pe-ru-si-nu-wa* 'last year's' correlates with *za-we-te* 'this year'; so also KN Gg 5637, with *pe-ru-si-*['last year's' correlated with *za-we-te-ro* 'this year's'.[10] It seems clear, in other words, that the idiomatic counterpart of Myc. /*perusinu̯os*/ 'this year's' is /*tˢāwetes*/ 'last year' (or its corresponding adjective forms). Further, Myc. *ne-wo* means rather '(physically) new' (as opposed to 'old') or 'young', and not specifically 'this year's': note, for example, the explicit collocation *ne-wo za-we*[*-te/-te-ro*] 'new ones, from this year' (KN X 658). And in any case, the presumed contamination would be an atypical one: "antonymic contamination"[11] normally operates on more marked antonyms (of the type 'light'/'heavy', etc.), and tends to produce clearer formal similarity (Lat. *levis / gravis* → Vulgar Lat. **grevis*, etc.). In the end, Lejeune's contamination theory is far from compelling.

3. The alternative to all this is to take the sequence **-nu̯o-* seriously, an approach that seems to have been envisioned (though it was not pursued) by HEUBECK (1963, p. 195). Yet any attempt to offer an explanation for such an odd-looking formant is hampered by the absence of comparanda. At first glance, it may seem that Ion. μοῦνος/Att. μόνος 'sole, alone' < Pr.-Gk. **mónu̯o-* provides such a comparandum, if one accepts the old conception of the form by MEYER (1859, p. 143) as "*σμονϝο-" (in his notation), based on PIE **sem-* 'one'. More specifically, in the updated version of this account by HAHN (1942, p. 88), Pr.-Gk. **hmonu̯o-* is described as a "thematic stem" **hm-o-* built to PIE **sem-*; this **hm-o-* is further derived with a formant "**-nu̯o-*", which Hahn takes to be a contamination of **-no-* (as in Gk. οἰνο- 'one', cf. Lat. *ūnus*, etc.) and **-u̯o-* (as in Hom. οἰ(ϝ)ο- 'one, alone', cf. Av. *aēuua-*, etc.). Yet none of this is attractive. There is, first of all, no evidence for a "thematic stem" **sm-o-* (> Pr.-Gk. **hm-o-*) belonging to **sem-*, nor is there any reason to believe in the existence (or possible creation) of such a form.[12]

[10] For PY Ma 225: *pe-ru-si-nu-wa* no doubt refers to an elliptical *a-pu-do-si*, cf. KN Ga 518 *za-we-te-ra a-pu-do-si.*

[11] See MALKIEL 1951, and more recently VINE 2006, pp. 142ff.

[12] The *actual* thematic derivative of **sem-* probably appears in ὁμός 'same' < **somh₂-ó-* (cf. Ved. *samá-*); and a zero grade **sm̥h₂-ó-* would not yield Gk. /hmo-/ in any case. (On **somh₂-ó-*, see recently PINAULT 2006, p. 88, with references.)

Moreover, there are few parallels for the type of Suffixhäufung seen in the alleged **hm-o-nu̯o-*, and no viable parallels for the contamination "**-no-* X **-u̯o-* → **-nu̯o-*". Finally, the very conception of Pr.-Gk. **mónu̯o-* as built on PIE **sem-* may be faulty: the basis may rather be PIE **men-* 'remain, stand fast' (see DE LAMBERTERIE 1990, pp. 193f.), in which case there is no formant "**-nu̯o-*" here at all.[13] We have thus, yet again, reached an impasse. It is time to suggest a new approach to the problem.

4. What emerges from the above discussion is that the adjective **perutinu̯o-* 'last year's' (beside its derivational basis **péruti* 'last year') should be considered on its own terms — that is, apart from -ινός, which may be unrelated (§**2.1** above), and discounting the unlikely contamination with **néu̯o-* (§**2.2**). When viewed in this way, the most salient point is that an adjectival suffix **-u̯o-* (often with "oppositional" value) is well attested with adverbial elements, as with (loc.) **dek̂si* 'on the right', whence the adjective **dek̂si-u̯ó-* 'right (as opposed to left)' (Hom. δεξι(Ϝ)ός, Gaul. *dexsiva*; cf. **dek̂s-u̯o-* in Go. *taihswa,* etc.), parallel to **dek̂si-no-* (Ved. *dákṣiṇa-*, OCS *desĭnŭ*), and many other such forms.[14] That being the case, one could say that the morphological problem with "**-nu̯o-*" is not actually the labial glide (which could simply belong to the formant **-u̯o-*), but rather the **-n-*. This then leads to the question as to whether an adverbial form **pérutin* (or, in theory, **pérutim*) could be defended as the basis of an adjectival derivative **perutin-u̯ó-* or **perutim-u̯ó-*.

5. I suggest that an affirmative answer to this question can be grounded in the theory of the PIE "ablative-instrumental suffix **-m*" — a conception originally due to DELBRÜCK and developed to some extent by BRUGMANN, WACKERNAGEL, and others, but more recently defended and elaborated by DUNKEL (1997, q.v. for earlier references).

5.1. Dunkel's full argumentation need not be recapitulated here; for present purposes, it should suffice to survey the following essential points. The fundamental claim is that an adverbial formant **-m* is common with expressions of both time and place (for which examples will be provided below). The formation is attested with both pronominal stems

[13] On the semantics of **món-u̯o-* ('alone' < *'the one who remains'), see BIRAUD 1996, with references.

[14] On "oppositional **-u̯o-*", see VINE 2006, pp. 148f., with earlier references (to which can be added PINAULT 1985, p. 363n78).

and nominal stems (the latter sometimes secondarily), and here both ablative and instrumental senses tend to be distinguishable in given cases. In addition, the formation is common with adverbial bases, where (perhaps predictably) the distinction between ablative and instrumental is harder to discern. Note especially that in formal terms, a common pattern of metanalysis (or false division) yields a formant "**-im*", extended from original sequences in **-i-m,* i.e., adverbs in **-m* based on *i*-stems. Thus, to take the anaphoric pronominal stem **(H)i-* (cf. Lat. *is* 'he'), an adverbial **i-m* (with ablatival sense) appears in Lat. *ex-im* 'from there', *in-de* 'id.'; and similarly for pronominal **g^{h}i-* (Lat. *hic* 'this'), note ablatival **g^{h}i-m(+k̂e)* in *hinc* 'from here'. But given suppletive **g^{h}i-* ~ **g^{h}o-* (Lat. nom. sg. masc. *hic* ~ acc. *hunc*), adverbial **g^{h}i-m* was reinterpreted as **g^h(o)-im,* whence a self-standing "*-im*", as in forms like *ōlim* 'at a distant time', *interim* 'meanwhile', and others (to say nothing of more immediate analogical formations like *illim/illinc, istim/istinc* 'from there', cf. *hinc*).[15]

5.2. Adverbial **-m* is also well-attested in Greek. Note especially, in Dunkel's attractive analysis, πρίν 'before' < **pri-m*, based on the **pri-* in Lat. *prior* 'earlier', OCS *prĭvŭ* 'first' (beside more widespread **pro*).[16] Here again, a metanalytic form has developed, with πρίν (cf. πρό) reanalyzed as πρ-ίν, whence a Greek adverbial time-formant "-ιν" — a descriptive fact of Greek that is already widely recognized.[17] This appears, for example, in forms like the following, based on old pronominal and particle stems:

(i) ὄπιν (also κάτοπιν, μέτοπιν) 'afterwards, in the future', unless this is an archaic **opi-m* (: Myc. *o-pi,* ὄπιθεν, etc.) comparable to **pri-m*;

(ii) Cret. αὐτιν, Rheg. αὐθιν 'back, again' ~ Ion., Arc. αὖτις, Att. αὖθις (cf. αὖ 'id.', αὐτός 'same');

(iii) perhaps πάλιν 'back' (the background of which is unclear, but which somehow belongs with πάλαι 'long ago').

A prominent form of this kind based on an old nominal stem (**h$_2$ói̯-u-*

[15] Important new data belonging here have recently been discussed by GOEDEGEBUURE (2007), who interprets HLuv. *zin* and *apin* (which function as the synchronic abl.-instr. forms of the deictic pronouns *za-* 'this' and *apa-* 'that', replacing expected **/zadi/* and **/abadi/*) as old adverbial forms of this type. (I thank Craig Melchert for bringing this material to my attention.)

[16] Differently (but, to my mind, improbably) on πρίν: KLINGENSCHMITT's conception of **pri-* followed by a zero grade of **en* 'in', as a locatival postposition (see NERI 2007, p. 62n170).

[17] See e.g. SCHWYZER 1939, p. 631; BUCK 1955, p. 105.

'life(time), age') that is often used adverbially may well appear in Thess. ἀιν (cf. αἶιν Hdn.) 'forever' (beside plain local advs. in **-i* [Lesb. ἄι, Ion. αἰι, Arc. ἀι], among other formations: Dor. αἰές, Ion. etc. αἰεί, etc.).[18] Not surprisingly, at any rate, the "time-formant" -ιν has been extended to various other forms, e.g. El. ὐσταριν 'later', Cret. αὐταμεριν 'on the same day' (vs. standard adverbial forms in -ον for these items: e.g. Att. ὕστερον, αὐθήμερον).[19]

6. The import of this material for Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo* is that it becomes possible to imagine, beside **péruti,* an early adverbial by-form **pérutim* (> Gk. **pérutin*), like Gk. adverbial **opin* beside **opi, *autin* (beside **autis*), **aiu̯in* (beside **aiu̯i*) (§**5.2**). Semantically, note also the prominence, among the **-i(-)m* forms, of adverbs meaning 'backwards/forwards (in time)' (starting with πρίν itself) — exactly comparable to **péruti* 'last year' and its possible by-form **pérutim.*

More specifically, in terms of semantics: the assignment of ablatival as opposed to instrumental value for **pérutim* is difficult, as often for **-(i)(-)m* forms from nominal bases (cf. §**5.1** on this point). But an ablatival origin seems possible in some cases (e.g. πρίν '(from) before'?), and can be suggested for **pérutim*: thus perhaps literally 'from last year', differing slightly in meaning from the plain locative **péruti* '(during) the preceding year'.[20] This could have resulted in corresponding adjectival derivatives, i.e.

(i) **perutim-u̯ó-* 'last year's' (ablatival, i.e. 'from last year') (or **pérutin* + **-u̯ó-*; see §**8** below on the chronology) > Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo*;

(ii) **peruti-nó-* 'last year's' (locatival, 'during the preceding year'; i.e., a delocative formation of the type Hom. εἰαρινός etc.) > Att. περυσινός (unless this goes back to a pre-Att. **perusinwos* that is directly comparable to Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo*; the lack of compensatory length-

[18] Strictly speaking, as José Luis García Ramón kindly reminds me, it may be difficult to exclude the possibility that Thess. ἀιν goes back to **aiu̯en,* with a raising of *e* to *i* before the nasal.

[19] See further DUNKEL (1997) for adverbial **-im* in other Greek adverbs and adverb conglomerates: ἀριστίνδην 'according to rank'; ταυρίνδα 'like a bull'; κυλίνδω 'roll' < *κυ(κ)λίνδα [παίζειν] (RISCH 1972, p. 352), implying (instr.) *κύκλιν 'with a wheel'; etc.

[20] In a general way, one may compare gen.-abl. **pr-es-* beside dat.-loc. **pr-ei-* in Att.-Ion. etc. πρέσβυς vs. Cret. etc. πρεῖγυς 'elder' (GARCÍA RAMÓN 1985).

ening in Attic resonant-glide sequences renders the form phonologically ambiguous, as already noted [§**2**]).

If this is so, the proposed ablatival sense of **perutim-u̯ó-* might be visible in the idiomatic use of Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo* with reference to debt (*o-pe-ro*) incurred 'from last year' or 'arising from last year' (as seen especially in the PY Ma series); likewise in expressions meaning 'from last year's allotment/allocation' (e.g. KN So 4442 *o-pe-ro … pe-ru-si-nwa ta-ra-si-ja*; cf. n. 10 above and MELENA 2001, p. 58 on PY Ma 225: *pe-ru-si-nu-wa* [scil. *a-pu-do-si*] … *o-pe-ro*).

However this may be, what is fundamental is the absolutely regular and predictable morphological make-up of the proposed **perutim-u̯ó-* (or **pérutin* + **-u̯ó-*) 'last year's', formed (at one stage or another) from adverbial **pérutim* '(from?) last year' by means of the "oppositional" suffix **-u̯o-* commonly used to derive adjectives from particles and adverbs (cf. §**4** above on **deĥsi-u̯ó-*etc.).

7. The first of two final observations concerns the relationship between the adverbial **pérutim* we have reconstructed and so-called "ν ephelkystikon". Indeed, by virtue of this feature, one could claim that a form **pérutim* might be directly attested in the ordinary variant "πέρυσιν" (well-attested beside πέρυσι), a type of form normally assumed to show "ν ephelkystikon" (e.g. RIX 1992, p. 134). This is not the place to explore this difficult and poorly-understood phenomenon; but DUNKEL (1997, p. 79) is probably correct in assuming, first of all, that the aetiology is "polygenetic" — i.e., that there may be a number of different sources for these facultative nasals — and, secondly, that adverbial **-m* might be part of this background.[21] If this is so, we can now add that the virtual synonyms **pérutim* (> **pérutin*, cf. §**8** below on the chronology) and **péruti* could have been prime contributors to the entire syndrome, even if (as seems likely) alphabetic Greek "πέρυσιν", synchronically, reflects a later application of the phenomenon. All of this makes clear, at any rate, that no "direct" survival of **pérutim* itself can really be demonstrated (i.e., would ever be visible), apart from Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo* (and possibly Att. περυσινός), and unless this form happens to lurk behind some early instances of "πέρυσιν".

[21] For the latter point: note in particular Dunkel's discussion of instrumental -φι beside -φιν, with the latter interpreted as a "hyper-instrumentalization" in **-b^{h}i-m*, via adverbial (in this case instrumental) **-m*.

8. As it happens, finally, the development of the sequence **-mu̯-* in Greek is thus far unknown, owing to the lack of even a single example.[22] Problematic in a different way is the status of word-final **-m* in Mycenaean: a few forms (e.g. *e-me* 'one' [dat. sg. masc.] = /*hem-ei*/) may suggest that it was still intact (see e.g. LEJEUNE 1972, p. 145), while several uncertain instances of phrasal spellings without word division have been thought to point in the other direction, e.g. *i-qo-na-to-mo* PY Eq 146.11, if this reflects /*(h)ikku̯ōn art*^{h}*mos*/, showing thematic gen. pl. /*-ōn*/ < **-ōm* (see HAJNAL 2006, §15c). Thus, strictly speaking, Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo* could reflect a **-u̯o-* formation to an already-existing **pérutin,* if **-m* > /-n/ had already occurred. Nevertheless, it seems doubtful that **-u̯o-* could have been used in such a productive way, even at that stage; cf. CHANTRAINE (1933, pp. 122, 124): "La plupart des mots en -Ϝος semblent dater, sinon de l'indo-européen, au moins du grec commun"; "le suffixe *-wo-* était mort en grec". It may be preferable to assume, then, that Myc. *pe-ru-si-nu-wo* continues a relatively old formation **perutim-u̯ó-* (with **-mu̯-* still intact). Thus, regardless of whether final **-m* had already developed to /-n/ by Mycenaean times, this formation may provide evidence suggesting a development **-mu̯-* > /-nu̯-/ (cf. perhaps **-mi̯-* > /-ni̯-/), thereby allowing us to fill this gap in the prehistory of Greek phonology.

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[22] Explicitly SIHLER (1995, p. 185): "there are no examples of μϜ".

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